

Ἰαμβικὰ Ἀδέσποτα

Iambic Fragments Anonymous on Geography and Verse

eul_aid: ajq

Period: Ἀρχαϊκή [Archaic](#)
Dialect: Μικτὰὶ διάλεκτοι [Mixed Dialects \(frg\)](#)
Domain: Ποίησις [Poetry](#)
Format: Συναγωγή [Collection](#)

Iambic Fragments Anonymous is not a single author but a modern scholarly designation for unattributed Greek iambic poetry. The fragments span from the 7th century BCE to the 4th century CE, covering the genre's entire lifespan from its Archaic origins to later Hellenistic and Imperial revivals. These verses survive anonymously due to the fragmentary transmission process, often preserved through quotations in later authors or on papyri where attributions were lost.

The corpus consists of scattered unattributed iambic verses collected from diverse sources like papyri and anthologies. Their content aligns with generic conventions, featuring satire, personal invective, moralizing, and narrative.

These fragments demonstrate the breadth and longevity of the iambic tradition beyond its canonical authors. They provide crucial evidence for the genre's thematic and metrical evolution over nearly a millennium and illuminate popular or sub-literary poetic strands. As fragments, they also highlight the fragmentary nature of classical transmission and preserve otherwise lost poetic voices.

Works (1)

- Ἀποσπάσματα περὶ Γεωγραφίας · [Fragments on Geography](#) · 55 passages